

Chapter 16 — 이민 생활 · Life as an immigrant

What this chapter covers

어휘	Vocabulary 외국인의 고충과 노력 — the hardships foreigners meet, and what they do about them
문법	Grammar 동형-을지도 모르다 / 명치고 — it may well be that · for a ..., considering
활동	Activities 한국 생활 경험담 말하기, 나의 꿈에 대한 글 쓰기 — telling the story of your life here; writing about your dream
문화와 정보	Culture & information 사회통합프로그램과 한국 국적 취득 — the KIIP programme and acquiring Korean nationality

This is the last chapter of the book, and it is about you. Every earlier chapter taught you to handle some corner of Korean life; this one asks what the whole of it has cost and what you intend to make of it. The culture page is about the very programme you are sitting in.

The two grammar points are both about uncertainty held steadily. -을지도 모르다 says a thing may well turn out to be so; 치고 measures something against the class it belongs to. Between them you can talk about a future you cannot yet see and about how your own experience compares with everyone else's.

이 사람들은 한국에서 사는 동안 어떤 일이 있었던 것 같아요?

What do you think these people have been through while living in Korea?

여러분은 한국에서 살면서 어떤 꿈을 이루고 싶어요?

What dream would you like to achieve while living in Korea?

Three images that between them sketch the arc of this chapter. A hand filling in a 귀화 허가 신청서, the application for permission to naturalise. The front of ĐÀO 베트남 쌀국수, a Vietnamese pho shop, with the tall congratulatory flower stand that Korean businesses receive on their opening day. And a woman in a chef's apron, standing as if the shop were hers.

The flower stand outside the restaurant is a 화환, and the sash on it reads 축 개업 — congratulations on opening. Sending one is the standard way to mark someone's new business, and they are so much a fixture that a shop without one on its first day looks unloved.

귀화 is naturalisation, acquiring a new nationality. It is a much bigger step than 영주권, permanent residence, which lets you stay indefinitely without changing citizenship. Both appear in this chapter, and the difference between them matters enormously in practice.

어휘 — Vocabulary

1. 여러분은 한국에서 살면서 어떤 어려움을 겪었어요?

1. What difficulties have you faced while living in Korea?

의사소통 문제 — trouble communicating

대화가 잘 통하지 않아서 답답했어요.

Conversations didn't get through, and it was frustrating.

한국어를 못 알아들어서 의사소통에 어려움이 있었어요.

I couldn't follow Korean, so communicating was hard.

경제적인 문제 — money trouble

무슨 일을 해야 할지 몰라 막막했어요.

I had no idea what work to do, and I felt completely at a loss.

한국의 돈 단위가 익숙하지 않아 물건을 살 때마다 힘들었어요.

Korean money units were unfamiliar, so buying anything was a struggle.

주변 사람과의 갈등 — friction with people around you

주변 사람들과 사고방식이 달라서 갈등을 겪었어요.

People around me thought differently, and that caused friction.

제가 외국인이라서 차별 대우를 당했어요.

I was treated differently because I'm a foreigner.

문화 차이 — cultural difference

한국 문화를 잘 몰라서 실수하는 일이 많았어요.

I didn't know Korean culture well, so I made a lot of mistakes.

고향의 문화와 한국의 문화가 달라서 문화 충격을 경험했어요.

My own culture and Korean culture differ, so I went through culture shock.

막막하다 is the feeling of facing something with no idea where to begin — not fear exactly, more a blankness. It is the word people reach for about the first months in a new country, and it recurs in this chapter's speech and reading.

당하다 marks something unwelcome done to you: 차별 대우를 당하다, 사기를 당하다, 무시를 당하다. It is the verb Korean uses to make a victim of the subject, and it is never neutral — you would not say 도움을 당하다.

2. 여러분은 어려움이 있을 때 어떤 선택을 했어요?

2. When you had difficulties, what did you choose to do?

극복하다

to overcome it

주변에 도움을 청하다

to ask the people around you for help

법에 호소하다

to appeal to the law

포기하다

to give up

혼자 고민하다

to brood on it alone

불의에 타협하다

to compromise with injustice

The book sets these two groups against each other with a smiling and an uneasy face, and the second group is worth reading carefully. 혼자 고민하다 — carrying it alone — is grouped with giving up and with compromising with injustice, which is a deliberate and rather pointed piece of teaching.

법에 호소하다 is to take a matter to the law. For foreign residents this is less remote than it sounds:

외국인종합안내센터 on 1345 gives free advice in many languages, and labour offices handle unpaid-wage complaints regardless of visa status.

3. 다음과 같은 어려움을 겪을 때 어떻게 해야 해요?

3. What should you do when you meet these difficulties?

의사소통 문제

모르는 말은 그때그때 물어보다

ask about words you don't know as they come up

내가 들은 게 맞는지 바로 확인하다

check straight away that you heard right

경제적인 문제

주변 사람들에게 고민을 솔직하게 털어놓다

tell the people around you honestly what is worrying you

합리적으로 소비를 하다

spend sensibly

주변 사람과의 갈등

상대방의 입장을 이해하려고 노력하다

try to understand the other person's position

적극적으로 소통하면서 해결 방안을 찾다

communicate actively and look for a way to resolve it

문화 차이

문화 간 차이를 극복하려고 노력하다

make an effort to get past the differences between cultures

다양한 문화에 대해 이해하는 시간을 가지다

take time to understand a range of cultures

털어놓다 is to unburden yourself — literally to shake something out and set it down. It takes 고민, 비밀, 속마음 as its object, and it implies relief at having said the thing out loud.

그때그때 means 'as and when, each time it comes up'. Doubling a time word like this gives Korean a sense of recurring occasion: 하나하나 one by one, 번번이 every single time, 집집마다 house by house.

Grammar 1 — 동형-을지도 모르다

확실하지 않은 내용을 추측하거나 짐작하여 말할 때 사용한다.

Used to guess at or suppose something you are not certain about.

안젤라 지금 영주권을 신청하면 언제 받을 수 있을까요?

If I apply for permanent residence now, when might I get it?

후엔 요즘 신청자가 많아서 생각보다 시간이 걸릴지도 몰라요. 마음의 여유를 가지세요.

There are a lot of applicants at the moment, so it may well take longer than you'd think. Give yourself some patience.

예문 — Examples

가 휴대 전화가 또 고장이 났어요.

My phone has broken again.

나 수리비가 더 많이 들지도 모르니까 이번에 새 걸로 하나 사세요.

The repair might well cost more, so buy a new one this time.

하늘이 흐린 걸 보니까 오후쯤에 비가 올지도 모르겠어요.

The sky's overcast, so it may well rain around this afternoon.

외국에서 생활하다 보면 힘들고 어려운 일이 생길지도 모르지만 열심히 해 보겠습니다.

Living abroad, hard and difficult things may well come up, but I'm going to work at it.

Forms

겪다 → 겪을지도 모르다

after a consonant: -을지도 모르다

오다 → 올지도 모르다

after a vowel: -르지도 모르다

★ 힘들다 → 힘들지도 모르다

a ㄹ stem already has its ㄹ: just add 지도 모르다

많다 → 많을지도 모르다

after a consonant: -을지도 모르다

걸리다 → 걸릴지도 모르다

after a vowel: -르지도 모르다

Take the shape apart and it explains itself. -을지 is an embedded question — whether it will happen. 도 adds 'even'. 모르다 is not to know. So the whole thing is literally 'I don't even know whether it will happen', which in practice means it may well happen. The speaker is declining to rule it out.

That is why it is softer than -을 것 같다. -을 것 같다 offers your impression of what is likely; -을지도 모르다 raises a possibility without committing to it at all. Use it when you want to warn someone of something without claiming to know.

The starred 힘들다 is the point to get right. Because 지 begins with a consonant, a ㄹ-final stem keeps its ㄹ: 힘들지도 모르다, never 힘드지도. Compare what happened to that same ㄹ in 힘드데 and 사네요, where it dropped before ㄴ. The ㄹ vanishes before ㄴ, ㅈ and ㅊ endings, and survives everywhere else.

모르다 conjugates as the rest of the sentence requires: 모릅니다, 모르겠어요, 모르지만, 모르니까. The example sentences here show four of those, and the meaning of the construction does not change with any of them.

1. 그림을 보고 보기와 같이 친구와 이야기해 보세요.

1. Look at the pictures and talk with a classmate as in the model.

미래의 교통은 어떻게 될까요?

What will transport be like in the future?

보기 교통 · 자동차 스스로 운행하다 → 운전자 없이 자동차가 스스로 운행할지도 몰라요.

Model: transport · cars drive themselves → Cars may well drive themselves with no driver.

하늘을 나는 차가 나오다

flying cars may appear

불치병을 치료하다

incurable diseases being cured

겨울이 사라지다

winter disappearing

초등학교가 사라지다

primary schools disappearing

1) 의학 기술의 발전 · 알약으로 식사를 대신하다

advances in medicine · a pill replacing a meal

2) 지구 온난화 · 동물들이 멸종하다

global warming · animals going extinct

3) 저출산 · 길에서 아이를 보기가 힘들다

the falling birth rate · rarely seeing a child in the street

The chart under 저출산 plots 출생아 수, annual births, in 만 명 — units of ten thousand. The book prints 86 for 1980, 65 for 1990, 43 for 2000, 35 for 2010 and 32 for 2020: from about 860,000 births a year down to about 320,000. It is one of the starkest figures in this book, and it is why the exercise can treat vanishing primary schools as a plausible guess rather than a joke.

불치병 is 불 not + 치 cure + 병 illness — an incurable disease. The same 불 negates a great many Sino-Korean words: 불가능 impossible, 불편 inconvenient, 불의 injustice, which you met on the previous page.

2. 여러분은 10년 후에 어떤 모습으로 살고 있을까요? '-을지도 모르다'를 사용해 이야기해 보세요.

2. What might your life look like in ten years? Talk about it using -을지도 모르다.

고향에서 큰 호텔의 사장이 되어 있을지도 몰라요.

I may well be running a big hotel back home.

되어 있을지도 몰라요 stacks the resultative -어 있다 under the pattern: not 'I may become' but 'I may already have become and still be'. It is a small touch that moves the sentence ten years out rather than describing a single moment of change.

단어장 — Vocabulary

불치병

an incurable disease

멸종하다

to become extinct

사라지다

to disappear

Grammar 2 — 명치고

앞의 말 전체가 예외 없음을 나타내거나 그중 예외적임을 나타낼 때 사용한다.

Used to say that the whole group takes no exceptions, or that this one is an exception within it.

이링 선생님, 한국 생활이 힘들어서 그냥 고향에 돌아가 버릴까 이런 생각이 들어요.

Teacher, life in Korea is hard and I keep thinking I might just go home.

정아라 외국에서 사는 사람치고 안 힘든 사람은 없으니까 힘을 내세요.

There's no one living abroad who doesn't find it hard, so keep your spirits up.

예문 — Examples

가 면접이 벌써 끝났어요? 더 오래 걸릴 줄 알았는데요.

The interview is over already? I thought it would take longer.

나 그러게요. 중요한 면접치고 빨리 끝난 편이에요.

I know. For an important interview, it finished quite quickly.

아이들치고 만화책이나 게임을 안 좋아하는 아이가 없다.

There is no child who doesn't like comics or games.

이 물건은 중고치고 상태가 아주 좋다.

For a second-hand item, this is in very good condition.

Forms

외국인 → 외국인치고

치고 attaches straight to the noun

아이 → 아이치고

치고 attaches straight to the noun

치고 has two readings that look opposite but are not. Either it says the group admits no exceptions — 아이들치고 ...없다, there is no child who doesn't — or it says this particular case is an exception within its group — 중고치고 상태가 좋다, good for second-hand. One particle, two jobs.

What tells them apart is the clause. The 'no exceptions' reading needs a negative: 없다, 안, 못. If the sentence is positive, you are in the 'considering it's a ...' reading. Check for the negative first and the ambiguity disappears.

치고는 is the same particle with 는 added, and it leans harder on the 'considering' reading: 중고치고는 상태가 좋다 sounds a shade more emphatic than 중고치고. In the 'no exceptions' use you would not add 는.

Note the register: 치고 belongs to speech and to informal writing. In a formal document you would reach for something like -에 비해 or -을 감안하면 instead. The dialogue and the speech in this chapter are exactly where it belongs.

1. 보기와 같이 친구와 이야기해 보세요.

1. Talk with a classmate as in the model.

가 한국에서 영주권을 신청해서 받는 데까지 얼마나 걸렸어요?

How long did it take you to apply for and receive permanent residence in Korea?

나 5년 걸렸어요. 영주권 받는 사람치고 좀 오래 걸렸죠.

It took five years. For someone getting permanent residence, that's on the long side.

평균 vs 실제 — average against actual**보기 · 한국에서 영주권을 신청해서 받다 · 평균 3년 · 실제 5년**

model · applying for and receiving permanent residence · average 3 years · actual 5

1) 취업할 수 있을 정도로 한국어를 잘하다 · 평균 3년 · 실제 1년 반

being good enough at Korean to get a job · average 3 years · actual 18 months

2) 가게 개업을 준비하다 · 평균 1년 · 실제 6개월

preparing to open a shop · average 1 year · actual 6 months

3) 취업을 위해 자격증을 따다 · 평균 2년 · 실제 1년 반

getting a qualification for work · average 2 years · actual 18 months

The table is built so that the model runs long and the other three run short. That is deliberate: it makes you produce 좀 오래 걸렸죠 once and 좀 빨리 걸렸죠 or 빠른 편이에요 three times, so you practise the comparison in both directions.

자격증을 따다 is to obtain a certificate or licence — 따다 here is 'to win, to gain', the same verb used for picking fruit and for winning a medal. 자격증을 받다 would sound as though someone simply handed it to you.

2. 자신의 한국 생활에 대해 '치고'를 사용해 친구들과 이야기해 보세요.

2. Talk with classmates about your own life in Korea, using 치고.

한국 문화에 적응하는 데 오래 걸렸어요?

Did it take you long to adapt to Korean culture?

한국 생활이 힘들었어요?

Has life in Korea been hard?

한국 드라마를 이해하는 데까지 얼마나 걸렸어요?

How long did it take before you could follow Korean dramas?

저는 한국 문화에 적응하는 데 1년쯤 걸린 것 같아요. 한국에서 사는 외국인치고 좀 오래 걸린 편이에요.

I think it took me about a year to adapt to Korean culture. For a foreigner living in Korea, that's on the long side.

단어장 — Vocabulary**영주권**

permanent residence

개업

opening a business

말하기 — Speaking

1. 후엔 씨가 사회통합프로그램 수료식에서 소감 발표를 하고 있습니다. 다음과 같이 이야기해 보세요.

1. 후엔 is giving a speech at her KIIP completion ceremony. Practise speaking as below.

안녕하십니까? 오늘 소감을 발표하게 된 후엔이라고 합니다.

Good afternoon. My name is 후엔, and I've been asked to say a few words today.

저는 한국에 온 지 6년 정도 됐는데요. 이렇게 기쁜 자리에 서니까 힘들었던 지난날이 생각납니다.

I've been in Korea about six years now. Standing here on such a happy occasion, I find myself remembering the hard days.

외국에서 사는 사람치고 힘들지 않은 사람이 없겠지만 저도 처음 한국에 왔을 때는 한국 사람과 의사소통이 안 돼서 고생을 많이 했습니다.

There's probably no one living abroad who hasn't found it hard, and when I first came to Korea I too had a bad time of it, unable to make myself understood.

그럴 때마다 주변 사람들에게 물어보면서 문제를 해결했습니다.

Every time that happened, I asked the people around me and worked the problem out.

그리고 일자리를 찾지 못해 막막할 때도 있었습니다.

And there were times when I couldn't find work and felt completely at a loss.

그럴 때도 할 수 있다는 자신감을 갖고 열심히 살았습니다.

Even then I held on to the confidence that I could do it, and I lived hard.

제가 이런 경험을 하고 나니까 한국에 와서 저처럼 어려움을 겪는 외국인들이 많겠다는 생각이 들었습니다.

Having been through all this, it struck me that there must be many foreigners who come to Korea and struggle as I did.

그래서 앞으로는 외국인을 돕기 위한 모임을 만들어서 어려움을 겪는 사람들에게 도움을 주면서 살고 싶습니다.

So from now on I'd like to start a group to help foreigners, and live giving help to people who are struggling.

지금까지 부족한 제 이야기를 들어 주셔서 감사합니다.

Thank you for listening to my inadequate account.

This speech is the chapter's own grammar in use: 외국인치고 ...없겠지만 in the third sentence, and the whole shape of the thing — hardship, what she did about it, what she intends next — is the frame the writing task will ask you to reproduce.

부족한 제 이야기 — 'my inadequate account' — is formulaic modesty, not self-criticism. Korean speeches routinely close by belittling what has just been said, and the audience reads it as courtesy. Saying it will make you sound like someone who has been to a few of these.

소감 is what you felt about an occasion, and 소감을 발표하다 is a fixed event in Korean ceremonies: someone is asked to stand and say what the experience meant. If you complete a KIIP level, you may well be that someone.

이렇게 바꿔서 연습해 보세요 — Practise with these substitutions

1) 한국 사람과 의사소통이 안 돼서 고생을 많이 했다 · 주변 사람들에게 물어보다 · 일자리를 찾지 못해 막막할 때가 있었다
couldn't communicate and had a hard time · asked people around · times of being at a loss for work

2) 문화가 달라서 문화 충격을 받았다 · 한국 역사와 문화를 공부하다 · 한국어 공부가 어려워서 실력이 늘지 않을 때가 있었다
culture shock from the differences · studied Korean history and culture · times when Korean wasn't improving

2. 사회통합프로그램 수료식에서 여러분의 소감 발표를 해 보세요.

2. Give your own speech at a KIIP completion ceremony.

한국에서 살면서 힘들었던 부분
what has been hard about living in Korea

극복하기 위해 한 노력
what you did to get past it

단어장 — Vocabulary

수료식
completion ceremony

소감
one's impressions, a few words

수료 and 졸업 are not the same. 졸업 is graduating from a school with a degree or diploma; 수료 is completing a course of study. KIIP issues 수료, which is why the ceremony is a 수료식.

듣기 — Listening

1. 여러분은 한국에서 성공한 이민자를 본 적이 있습니까?

1. Have you ever seen an immigrant who has succeeded in Korea?

방송 프로그램에 결혼 이민자가 나와서 유창하게 말하는 것을 본 적이 있어요.

I've seen a marriage immigrant on a TV programme speaking fluently.

토론 프로그램에 여러 명의 외국인 유학생이 나와서 이야기하는 것을 봤어요.

I saw several foreign students talking on a discussion programme.

2. 앵커와 한현수 씨가 이야기합니다. 잘 듣고 질문에 답해 보세요.

2. A news anchor is talking to 한현수. Listen carefully and answer.

1) 어렸을 때 한현수 씨의 꿈은 무엇이었습니까?

1) What was 한현수's dream as a child?

2) 한현수 씨는 꿈을 이루고 싶은 사람에게 어떤 말을 해 주었습니까? 내용을 완성해 보세요.

2) What did 한현수 say to people who want to achieve a dream? Complete the text.

() 안 되는 일이 없어요. 그리고 항상 () 생각하다 보면 언젠가 꿈이 이루어질 거예요.

() there is nothing that cannot be done. And if you keep () in mind, one day the dream will come true.

3) 들은 내용과 같으면 ○, 다르면 X 하세요.

3) Mark ○ if it matches what you heard, X if not.

① 한현수 씨는 학교생활에 잘 적응했다.

한현수 adapted well to school life.

② 한현수 씨는 어릴 때부터 옷에 관심이 많았다.

한현수 was interested in clothes from an early age.

③ 한현수 씨는 힘든 일이 있을 때 포기하고 좌절했다.

When things got hard, 한현수 gave up and lost heart.

The gapped sentence in question 2 is worth learning whole even before you hear the recording, because it is a set piece of Korean encouragement: 마음먹기에 달렸다 — it depends on making up your mind — and 생각하다 보면, which means 'if you keep thinking about it, in time...'. The pattern -다 보면 turns repetition into eventual result.

Question 3 is built so that at least one statement contradicts the recording; the phrasing 포기하고 좌절했다 in ③ sits against everything else this chapter says about persistence, which is a fair hint about where it is going.

단어장 — Vocabulary

영광

an honour

비결

the secret, the knack

마음먹다

to make up one's mind

영광입니다 — 'it's an honour' — is what you say when introduced on a stage or thanked publicly. 비결 is the secret behind someone's success, and a Korean interviewer will almost always ask for it: 성공의 비결이 뭐예요?

발음 — Pronunciation

부딪힐 [부디칠]

bu-di-chil

맞히는 [마치는]

ma-chi-neun

앓히고 [안치고]

an-chi-go

1) 문제에 부딪힐 때도 많아서 고생을 했습니다.

1) I often ran up against problems, and had a hard time of it.

2) 이 문제를 먼저 맞히는 분에게 선물을 드리겠습니다.

2) I'll give a prize to whoever gets this question right first.

3) 아이를 따로 앉히고 싶은데요. 의자 좀 주시겠어요?

3) I'd like to seat the child separately. Could I have a chair?

All three are aspiration: a ㅎ meeting a plain consonant fuses with it and produces the aspirated one. Here the ㅎ comes second — ㅈ + ㅎ gives [ㅊ], so 부딪히다 is [부디치다]. It is the same rule you met from the other side in 좋지요 [조치요], where the ㅎ came first.

앉히고 shows the extra step. The stem 앉- ends in the cluster ㅈ; the ㄴ stays in place and the ㅈ moves on to meet the ㅎ, giving [안] + [치고]. Clusters split like this whenever the second consonant has somewhere to go.

맞히다 and 맞추다 are confused even by Koreans. 맞히다 is to get something right or to hit a target — 답을 맞히다, 정답을 맞히다. 맞추다 is to fit things together or align them — 시간을 맞추다, 옷을 맞추다. The quiz-show sentence above needs 맞히는.

읽기 — Reading

1. 발표자들은 어떤 꿈을 가지고 있습니까? 여러분은 어떤 꿈이 있습니까?

1. What dreams do the speakers have? What is your dream?

이민자 한국어 말하기 대회 — Immigrants' Korean speech contest

주제

Theme

나의 꿈 — My dream

발표 순서 — Running order

저의 꿈은 간호사입니다.

My dream is to be a nurse.

나의 꿈, 문화 전도사

My dream: to be an ambassador for my culture

세계적인 통역사를 위해 달려가겠습니다.

I'll press on towards becoming a world-class interpreter.

한식 조리사의 꿈, 한국에서 이루겠습니다.

My dream of being a Korean-cuisine chef — I'll achieve it here.

미래의 꿈, 저와 함께 도전해 보세요.

Dreams of the future: come and take up the challenge with me.

전도사 originally means an evangelist, someone who spreads a faith. Used as 문화 전도사 it keeps the zeal but not the religion: someone who carries their own culture to other people. Korean makes this kind of metaphorical job title easily — 홍보 대사, 친선 대사.

Every one of these five titles is a complete Korean sentence or phrase of the kind you could put at the top of your own talk. Notice how many use -겠- to announce an intention: 달려가겠습니다, 이루겠습니다. That is the register of a public undertaking.

2. 꿈을 이루기 위해서는 어떻게 해야 합니까?

2. What do you have to do in order to achieve a dream?

끊임없이 도전하다

to keep taking on challenges without a break

자기 계발을 하다

to develop yourself

힘과 열정을 쏟다 / 최선을 다하다

to pour in effort and passion / to do your utmost

어려움을 극복하다 / 고난을 이기다

to overcome difficulties / to prevail over hardship

끊임없이 is built from 끊다, to cut or break off, plus 없이, without: without a break. It is the standard Korean adverb for sustained effort, and it turns up in the reading passage on the next page in exactly that sense.

쏟다 is to pour out — you pour water, and you pour effort, passion and time. 열정을 쏟다 is more physical than English 'devote': it pictures the effort leaving you and going into the thing.

3. 다음은 '나의 꿈'에 대한 발표문입니다. 잘 읽고 질문에 답해 보세요.

3. Below is a speech on 'My dream'. Read it and answer the questions.

저의 꿈은 간호사입니다 — My dream is to be a nurse

안녕하세요? 저는 시부모를 모시면서 애 둘을 키우고 농사를 짓는 남편을 둔 평범한 주부입니다.

Hello. I'm an ordinary housewife: I look after my parents-in-law, raise two children, and my husband farms.

그리고 병원에서 근무한 지 1년이 채 안 된 새내기 간호조무사이기도 합니다.

I'm also a rookie nursing assistant, not quite a year into working at a hospital.

어릴 때부터 간호사를 꿈꾸던 제가 어떻게 낯선 한국 땅에서 꿈에 한발 다가갔는지 말씀드리기 위해 이 자리에 나왔습니다.

I've come here to tell you how someone who dreamed of nursing since childhood took a step closer to that dream on unfamiliar Korean soil.

저는 2009년 베트남에서 남편을 만나서 결혼하게 되었습니다.

I met my husband in Vietnam in 2009 and we married.

결혼 직후 남편에게 간호사가 되고 싶다고 말했더니 한국말이 서툴러서 어렵지 않겠느냐는 반응이었습니다.

Right after the wedding I told him I wanted to be a nurse, and his reaction was that it would surely be difficult with my shaky Korean.

그래서 우선 한국어 프로그램을 열심히 들으면서 한국 생활에 적응하기 위해 노력했습니다.

So first I threw myself into Korean language classes and worked at settling into life here.

한국 국적을 취득하고 난 후에는 한동안 아이들을 키우고 집안일을 하는 등 바쁜 일상이 계속되었습니다.

After I acquired Korean nationality, a busy stretch followed — raising the children, running the house.

그러던 어느 날 센터에서 간호조무사 취업 과정을 운영한다는 소식을 듣고 바로 '이것이 내 길이다'라는 생각이 들어 무조건 도전하게 되었습니다.

Then one day I heard the centre was running a nursing-assistant employment course, thought at once 'this is my path', and threw myself at it.

낮에는 공부하고 밤에는 늦게까지 배운 것을 복습하는 힘든 나날이 계속되었지만 꿈을 이룰 수 있을지도 모른다는 기대감에 몸이 힘든지도 몰랐습니다.

Hard days followed — studying by day and going back over it late into the night — but in the hope that I might actually achieve the dream, I hardly noticed how tired my body was.

저를 믿고 응원해 준 남편과 시부모님 덕분에 드디어 간호조무사 시험에 합격하고 지금은 집 근처의 작은 병원에 근무하고 있습니다.

Thanks to my husband and parents-in-law, who believed in me and cheered me on, I finally passed the nursing-assistant exam, and I now work at a small hospital near home.

그렇지만 저의 도전은 여기가 끝이 아닙니다. 다음에는 간호사가 되기 위해 끊임없이 도전하고 있습니다.

But my challenge doesn't end here. Next I'm working away at becoming a fully qualified nurse.

간호조무사에 비해 간호사가 되기는 훨씬 어려워서 언제 제가 간호사 자격증을 취득할지 모릅니다.

Becoming a nurse is far harder than becoming a nursing assistant, so I don't know when I'll get my nursing licence.

얼마나 걸릴지 모르겠지만 저는 제 꿈을 이루기 위해 최선을 다할 것입니다.

I don't know how long it will take, but I'll do everything I can to achieve my dream.

간호조무사 and 간호사 are different qualifications, and the whole shape of this speech depends on the gap between them. A 간호조무사 is a nursing assistant, trained through a course like the one the centre ran; a 간호사 is a registered nurse, which requires a nursing degree and a national licence. She has reached the first and is still climbing towards the second.

The chapter's grammar is doing real work in the fourth paragraph: 꿈을 이룰 수 있을지도 모른다는 기대감. Not 'I would achieve it' but 'the hope that I might' — precisely the tentative possibility -을지도 모르다 exists to express, and the reason the sentence is moving rather than boastful.

몸이 힘든지도 몰랐습니다 is a different -는지 모르다: here it genuinely means she did not realise how tired she was, not that it might be so. The two are told apart by tense and context, and this sentence sits one line away from the other use — a nice accident of the text.

모시다 is the honorific verb for looking after or attending on someone senior — parents, parents-in-law, a guest of rank. 시부모를 모시다 means living with and caring for one's husband's parents, and in a Korean context it says a good deal about a household in three syllables.

한동안 is 'for a while, for a good stretch' — long enough to be worth mentioning but not permanent. Set beside 나날, days on end, and 드디어, at last, it is one of the words carrying the passage's sense of time being endured.

1) 이 사람의 직업은 무엇입니까?

1) What is this person's job?

→ 간호조무사입니다.

→ She is a nursing assistant.

2) 이 사람은 앞으로 무슨 일에 도전할 것입니까?

2) What will she take on next?

→ 간호사가 되기 위해 도전할 것입니다.

→ She will work towards becoming a registered nurse.

3) 윗글의 내용과 같으면 ○, 다르면 X 하세요.

3) Mark ○ if it matches the passage, X if not.

① 이 사람은 한국어 수업을 들으면서 간호조무사 공부를 했다.

She studied for the nursing-assistant course while taking Korean classes — , the Korean classes came first, years before the course

② 이 사람이 공부를 할 때 다른 사람의 도움을 받을 수 없었다.

She had no one's help while studying — , her husband and parents-in-law believed in her and cheered her on

③ 이 사람에게 간호사 자격증이 있어도 취업은 어려울 것이다.

Even with a nursing licence she'd struggle to find work — , the passage says nothing of the kind

All three statements are false, and each fails differently: ① rearranges the order of events, ② contradicts a stated fact, and ③ introduces something the passage never mentions. Being able to name which kind of wrong you are looking at is most of the skill in this question type.

단어장 — Vocabulary

모시다

to look after, to attend on (an elder)

새내기

a newcomer, a rookie

간호조무사

nursing assistant

직후
immediately after

나날
days on end

쓰기 — Writing

1. 여러분의 꿈은 무엇입니까? 그 꿈을 이루기 위해 어떻게 해야 합니까? 그리고 꿈을 이루기 위해 지금 어떤 노력을 하고 있습니까? 다음 표에 메모해 보세요.

1. What is your dream? What do you have to do to achieve it? And what are you doing towards it now? Make notes in the table.

나의 꿈

my dream

해야 하는 것

what I have to do

지금 하고 있는 노력

what I am doing now

2. '나의 꿈'에 대한 글을 써 보세요.

2. Write a piece about 'My dream'.

The three boxes are the skeleton of the reading passage, in order: she named the dream, said what stood in the way of it, and described what she was doing about it. Fill them in and you have the shape of the essay before you write a sentence.

Two things from this chapter are worth putting into the writing deliberately. Use -을지도 모르다 for the part of the future you cannot promise — 언제 자격증을 딸지도 모르지만 — and use 치고 once to place yourself against others in your position. Those are the forms this chapter will be assessed on.

The reading passage ends on an undertaking rather than an achievement: 최선을 다할 것입니다. Ending your own piece the same way is both honest and idiomatic, and it avoids claiming a conclusion you have not reached yet.

문화와 정보 — 사회통합프로그램과 한국 국적 취득

사회통합프로그램은 이민자가 사회 구성원으로 적응하는 데에 필요한 한국어와 한국 문화에 대한 교육을 제공하는 프로그램이다.

The Korea Immigration and Integration Program provides immigrants with the education in Korean language and culture they need to settle as members of society.

사회통합프로그램은 0단계부터 5단계까지 있는데 각 단계의 평가를 통과하고 최종적으로 귀화용 종합 평가에 합격하면 한국 국적을 취득할 수 있다.

The programme runs from stage 0 to stage 5; pass the assessment at each stage and finally the comprehensive naturalisation assessment, and you can acquire Korean nationality.

즉, 한국 국적을 취득하려면 한국어 능력과 한국의 풍습에 대한 이해 등 한국 국민으로서의 기본 소양을 평가받아야 하는데 귀화용 종합시험이 이를 대신한다.

That is, to acquire Korean nationality you must be assessed on the basic attributes of a Korean citizen — competence in the language, understanding of Korean customs — and the comprehensive naturalisation examination serves in place of that.

한국 국적을 신청하려면 귀화 허가 신청서, 여권, 본국 신분증 원본과 사본, 범죄 경력 증명서, 가족 관계 증명서, 주민 등록 등본 등의 서류가 필요하다.

To apply for Korean nationality you need documents including the naturalisation application form, your passport, the original and a copy of your home-country ID, a criminal record certificate, a family relation certificate and a resident registration abstract.

먼저 귀화 허가 신청은 구비 서류를 가지고 주소지의 출입국 관리 사무소에 직접 가서 신청해야 한다.

First, the naturalisation application must be made in person, with the required documents, at the immigration office for your registered address.

그러면 귀화심사를 진행하게 되는데 서류 심사-면접 심사-실태 조사 등의 절차가 진행된다.

The naturalisation review then proceeds through document screening, an interview, and an investigation of your actual circumstances.

귀화 허가 통지서를 받게 되면 기본 증명서를 발급받아 시청이나 구청, 주민 센터에 제출해야 한다.

Once you receive the notice granting naturalisation, you must obtain a basic certificate and submit it to the city hall, district office or community centre.

귀화 허가일로부터 1년 이내에 본국 국적을 포기하고 주민 등록을 하게 되면 주민 등록증을 발급받을 수 있다.

If within one year of the naturalisation date you renounce your original nationality and complete resident registration, you can be issued a resident registration card.

You are inside the system this page describes. KIIP runs 0단계 to 5단계, and this book — 중급 2 — is 4단계. Passing its assessment takes you to 5단계, and the comprehensive assessment at the end of that is the one that can stand in place of the naturalisation aptitude test.

The single most consequential sentence is the last one. Korea does not, as a rule, permit dual nationality for naturalised adults: within a year you must renounce your original citizenship. Weigh that against 영주권, permanent residence, which lets you stay indefinitely and keep the passport you have.

실태 조사 — the investigation of actual circumstances — means officials may visit your home and speak to neighbours or your spouse to confirm the life you have described is the life you live. It is a normal part of the process rather than a sign of suspicion, but it is worth knowing about in advance.

범죄 경력 증명서, the criminal record certificate, generally has to come from your home country as well as Korea, and obtaining one from abroad with apostille and translation is the step that most often delays an application. Start it early.

Note the register of this passage: it is written in the plain 하다 style — 필요하다, 진행된다, 대신한다 — with no 요 and no 습니다 anywhere. That is the voice of official and expository writing, and being able to read it comfortably is much of what stage 4 is for.

질문 — Questions

1) 사회통합프로그램 귀화용 종합시험에 합격하면 어떤 혜택이 있습니까?

What is the benefit of passing the comprehensive naturalisation assessment? → 한국 국적을 취득할 수 있고 귀화용 종합시험이 기본 소양 평

2) 한국 국적을 신청하려면 어떤 서류가 필요합니까?

What documents are needed? → 귀화 허가 신청서, 여권, 본국 신분증 원본과 사본, 범죄 경력 증명서, 가족 관계 증명서, 주민 등록 등본 등

3) 여러분은 사회통합프로그램을 참여하면서 어떤 계획을 가지고 있는지 이야기해 보세요.

What are your own plans as you go through the programme?

배운 어휘 확인 — Vocabulary check

막막하다

to be at a complete loss

차별 대우를 당하다

to be discriminated against

법에 호소하다

to appeal to the law

불치병

an incurable disease

사라지다

to disappear

개업

opening a business

소감

one's impressions, a few words

비결

the secret, the knack

꿈

a dream

달려가다

to run towards, to press on

자기 계발

self-development

고난을 이기다

to prevail over hardship

새내기

a newcomer, a rookie

직후

immediately after

갈등을 겪다

to go through friction or conflict

극복하다

to overcome

불의에 타협하다

to compromise with injustice

멸종하다

to become extinct

영주권

permanent residence

수료식

completion ceremony

영광

an honour

마음먹다

to make up one's mind

전도사

an evangelist, an ambassador for something

끊임없이

without a break, ceaselessly

열정을 쏟다

to pour in one's passion

모시다

to look after, to attend on

간호조무사

nursing assistant

나날

days on end

That is the end of 중급 2, and of the four books that brought you here. You began by introducing yourself; you can now argue a case, read an official notice, and stand up at a ceremony and account for the years it took. 수고하셨습니다.